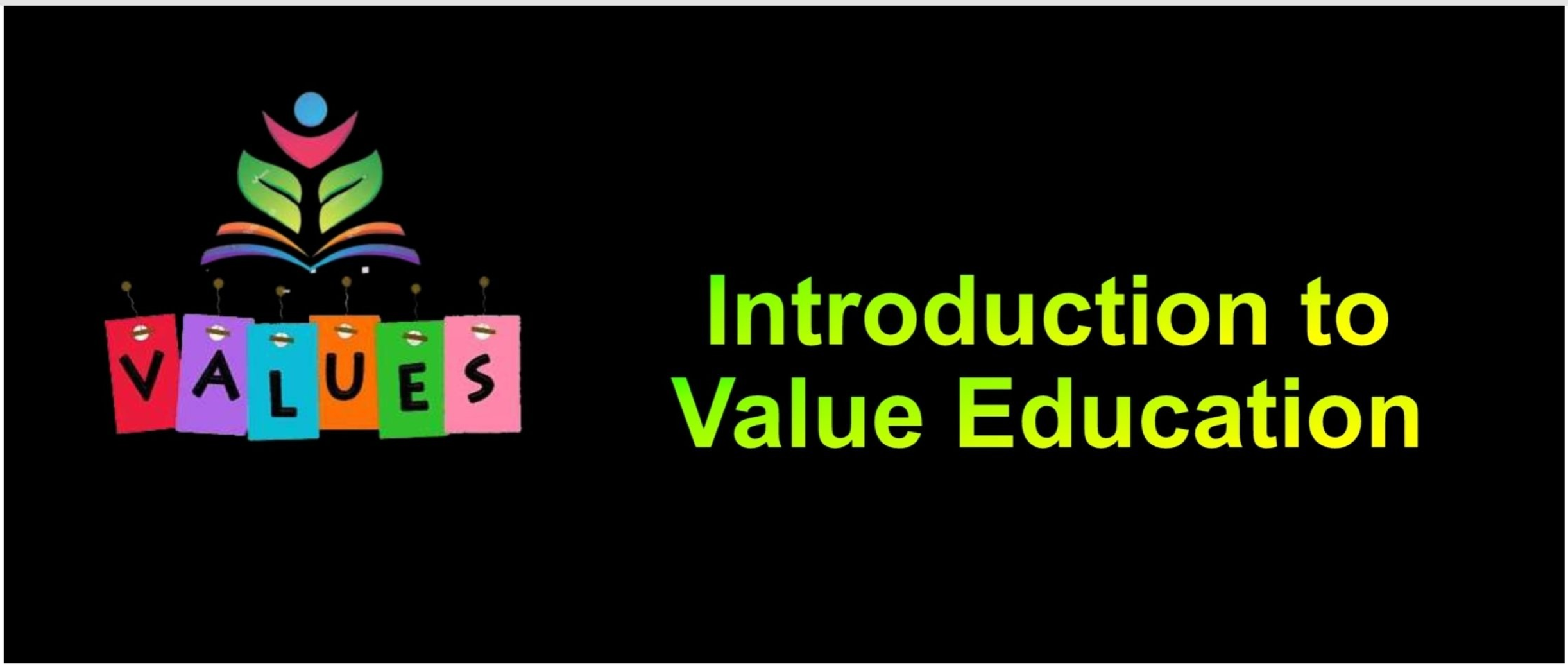

VALUES
Introduction to
Value Education

What is a Fulfilling Life?

- A fulfilling life includes **happiness**, **harmony**, and **prosperity**.
- Success is not just about wealth and recognition but meaningful relationships, health, and contentment.
- Society and nature thrive when individuals live in harmony with them.



- **Happiness:** Always being content within yourself.
- **Prosperity:** Having sufficient resources to meet your needs.
- **Harmony:** Building strong, meaningful relationships and coexisting peacefully with society and nature.
- True fulfillment lies in a balance of all these elements.



How Education Shapes Aspirations

- Education is more than acquiring skills—it helps us understand life holistically.
- It addresses real-life challenges like stress, incomplete goals, and unclear aspirations.
- Provides clarity on two questions: *What should we do?* and *How should we do it?*



Understanding Value and Skill Education

- **Value Education:** Helps clarify our aspirations and goals in life.
- **Skill Education:** Equips us with the tools and techniques to achieve these goals.
- Together, they create a balanced and fulfilling life.
- A holistic approach to achieving happiness and well-being



Image Source: https://www.billabonghighschool.com/

Understanding Value and Skill Education

- Recognizes the value of anything by its contribution to the larger system.
- Examples:
  - ✓A pen's value lies in its ability to write.
  - ✓A vegetable plant provides nutrition.
- Value education forms the foundation of all learning.



1. Correct Identification of Goals

- Encourages introspection on life's true purpose.
- Helps separate personal desires from external influences.
- Ensures goals are meaningful and aligned with individual purpose.
- Prevents reliance on borrowed aspirations that may not bring fulfillment.



Image Source: https://www.freepik.com/

Need for Value Education

2. Developing a Holistic Perspective

- Connects individuals to their roles in family, society, and nature.
- Highlights mutual fulfillment and interconnectedness at all levels of existence.
- Promotes gratitude for nature's effortless support (e.g., air, water, plants).



Image Source: https://www.istockphoto.com/

Need for Value Education

3. Clarity of Program for Daily Living

- Answers questions about inner peace, healthy habits, and nurturing relationships.
- Leads to happiness and harmony in all aspects of life.
- Eliminates confusion by providing clear, universal principles.



Image Source: https://esoftskills.com/

4. Evaluating Beliefs

- Helps evaluate beliefs shaping thoughts, actions, and goals.
- Differentiates between belief (unexamined acceptance) and understanding (clarity from truth).
- Promotes cooperation and harmony over competition and resource depletion.



Image Source: https://www.vecteezy.com/

Guidelines for Effective Value Education

- **Universal Applicability:** Relevant for all individuals.
- **Rational Foundation:** Encourages critical thinking.
- **Natural and Verifiable:** Promotes happiness and mutual fulfillment, validated through experience.
- **Comprehensive Coverage:** Covers all dimensions of human life.
- **Promoting Harmony:** Fosters inner peace and



Image Source: https://www.dreamstime.com/

- Recognizes value through contributions to the larger system.
- Encourages studying human life in relation to nature and existence.
- Includes:
  - ✓All aspects of life: thought, behavior, work, and realization.
  - ✓All levels of living: individual, family, society, nature, and existence.

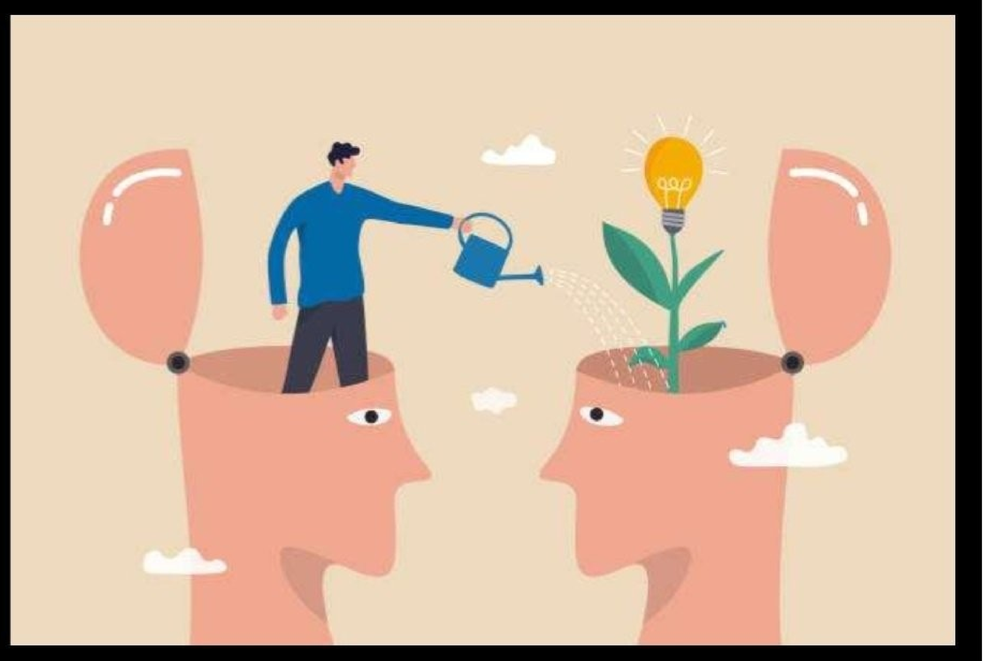


Image Source: https://www.istockphoto.com/

Process of Value Education – Self Exploration

What is Self-Exploration?

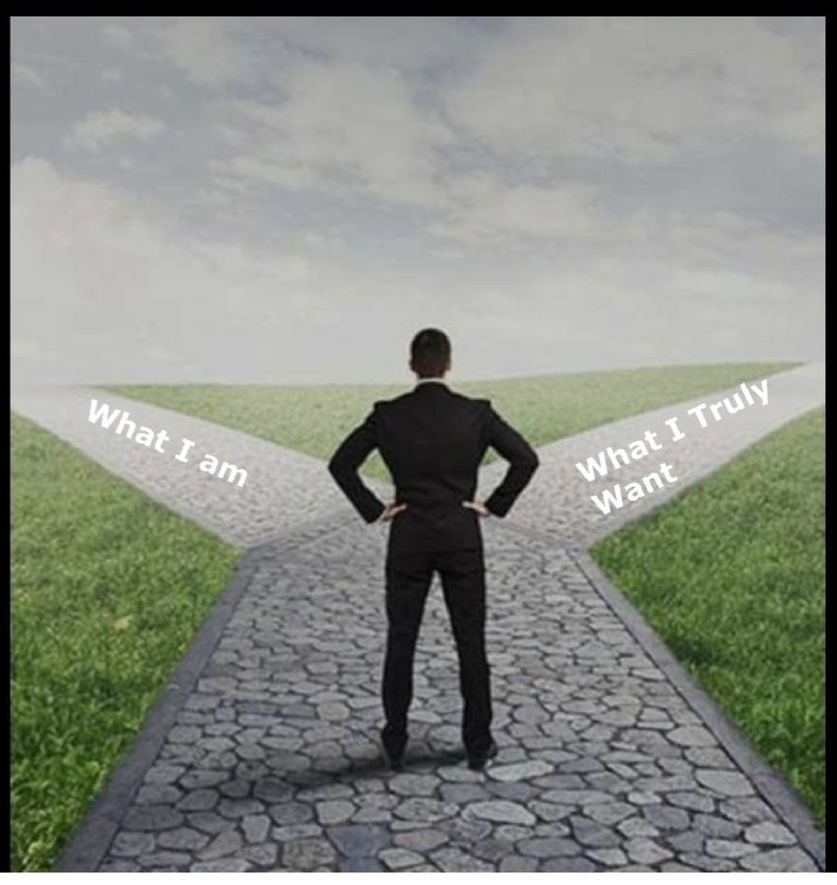
- A process to discover reality through personal observation and reflection.
- Guides us to evaluate ideas or proposals against our *natural acceptance*.
- Encourages decision-making based on understanding, not external influence.
- Resolves contradictions between actions and values for inner peace and harmony



Image Source: https://www.istockphoto.com/

The Dialogue Within

- **Interaction between:**
  - ✓**"What I Am" (current thoughts, desires, and actions).**
  - ✓**"What is Naturally Acceptable" (true values and intentions).**
- **Alignment leads to peace, growth, and balanced living.**



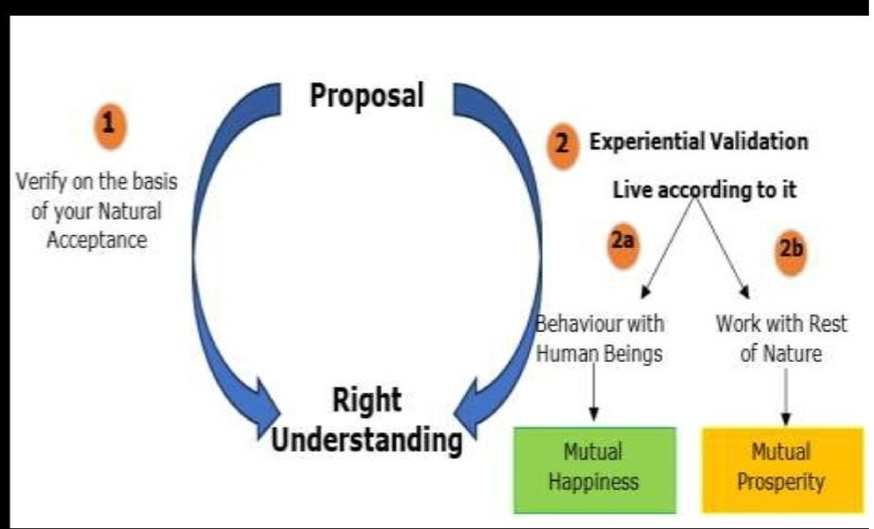
Two Crucial Questions:

- **Desire: What is our basic aspiration?**
  - ✓ **Helps identify life's purpose (e.g., happiness, prosperity).**
- **Programme: What is the way to fulfill this aspiration?**
  - ✓ **Provides a clear path (e.g., right understanding, harmonious relationships).**



1. **Natural Acceptance:**
   - ✓ Evaluate a proposal based on your inner sense of right or wrong.
   - ✓ Example: "Respect is natural in relationships."
2. **Experiential Validation:**
   - ✓ Test the proposal in real life.
   - ✓ Mutual happiness (in relationships) & Mutual prosperity (in interactions with nature).

- If both criteria are met, the proposal is valid.



Natural Acceptance in Action

- **Example: Respect in relationships.**
- **Step 1: Does respect align with your natural acceptance?**
- **Step 2: Practice respect and observe outcomes:**
  - ✓Leads to mutual happiness → Valid.
  - ✓Does not → Reevaluate.



Experiential Validation in Nature

- Example: Nurturing the environment.
- Check outcomes of actions:
  - ✓Better food production, healthier environment → Proposal is valid.
- Experiential validation strengthens confidence in natural acceptance.



Importance of Verification

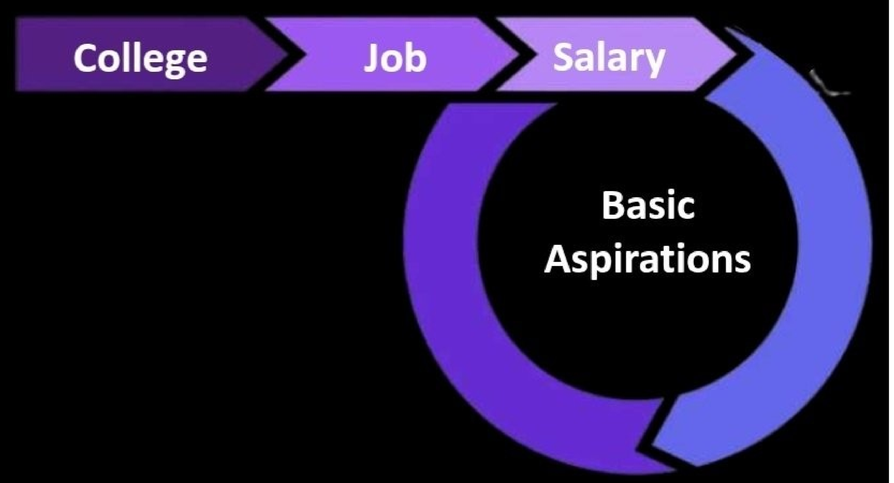
- Only proceed to validation if natural acceptance feels right.
- Doubts? Experiential validation is key.
- Alignment of values, thoughts, and actions simplifies life and promotes growth.



Image Source: https://shutterstock.com/

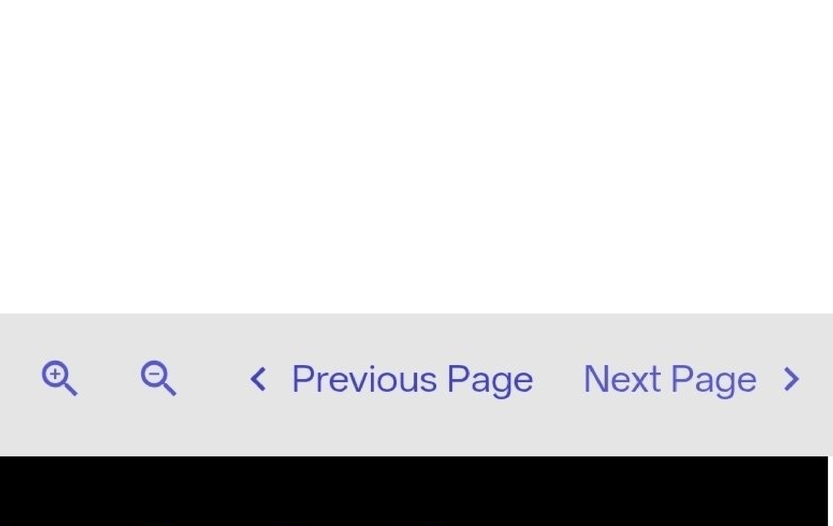
Continuous Happiness and Prosperity – the Basic Human Aspirations

- Actions and aspirations are driven by underlying motivations.
- Now imagine this perspective - You are often motivated by a series of connected goals.
- Examples: School > College > Job > Salary > Activities.
- Key Question: What is our goal or basic aspiration?
- Answer: A state of lasting fulfilment - continuous happiness and prosperity.



1. Basic Requirements for Fulfilling Aspirations

- Common gap: Disconnection between aspirations and current state.
- Key Elements:
  - ✓Physical Facilities (material needs).
  - ✓Relationships (emotional and social fulfilment).
  - ✓Right Understanding (clarity and balanced living).



Reflecting on Our Efforts

- Questions to consider:
  - ✓How much effort goes into physical facilities?
  - ✓How much effort into nurturing relationships?
- Major source of unhappiness: Lack of fulfilling relationships, not material wealth.
- Right understanding helps balance efforts and achieve fulfilment.

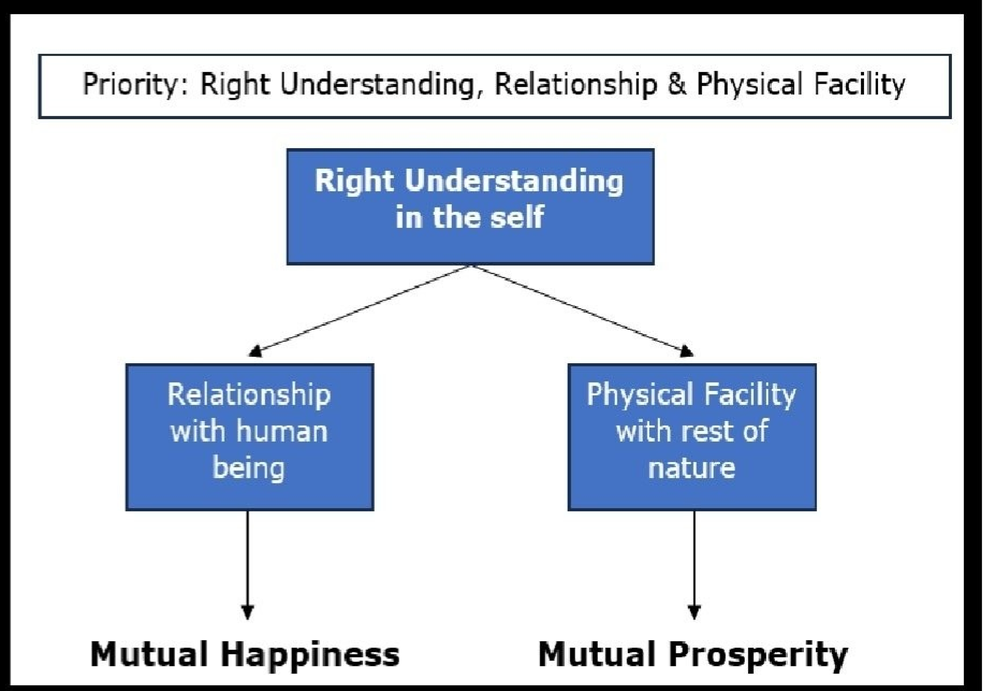


Physical Facilities

Human Consciousness: Prioritizing all three aspects in the right order:

- ✓Right Understanding.
- ✓Fulfilling Relationships.
- ✓Adequate Physical Facilities.

- Aim for: Sufficient facilities, happiness, and prosperity.



Physical Facilities

Animal vs. Human Consciousness

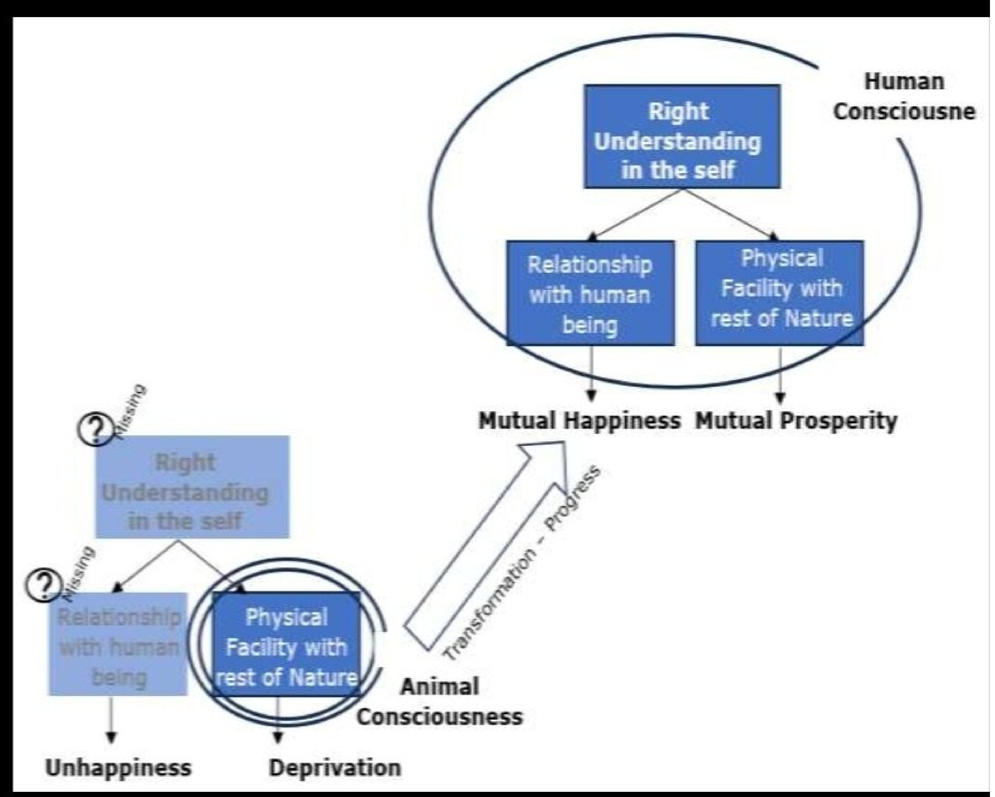
- Animal Consciousness: Focus only on physical facilities.
- Human Consciousness: Balanced focus on all three aspects.
- True development = Shift to "human consciousness."



Image Source: https://www.abc.net.au/

3. Development of Human Consciousness

- **Goal:** Transform from animal consciousness to human consciousness.
- Modern focus on material wealth overlooks inner fulfilment.
- **Holistic Development:** Prioritize right understanding, relationships, and physical facilities.



4. Role of Education-Sanskar

- **Education:** Develops right understanding.
- **Sanskar:** Instills commitment and preparation for living with this understanding.
- **Goals:**
  - ✓Right understanding.
  - ✓Harmonious relationships.
  - ✓Sustainable physical needs

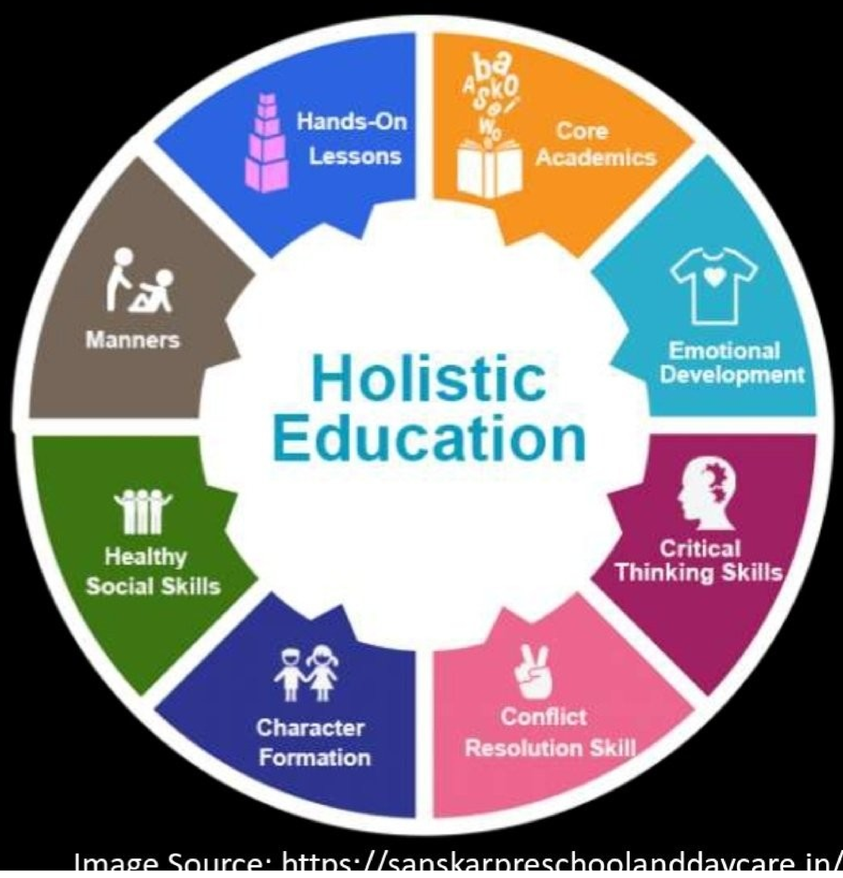


Image Source: https://sanskarpreschoolanddaycare.in/

Gaps in the Current Education System

- **Lack of focus on:**
  - ✓Development of Right understanding.
  - ✓Emphasizing relationships & cooperation
  - ✓Identifying physical needs and sustainable production.
- **Current system prioritizes competition and consumption.**

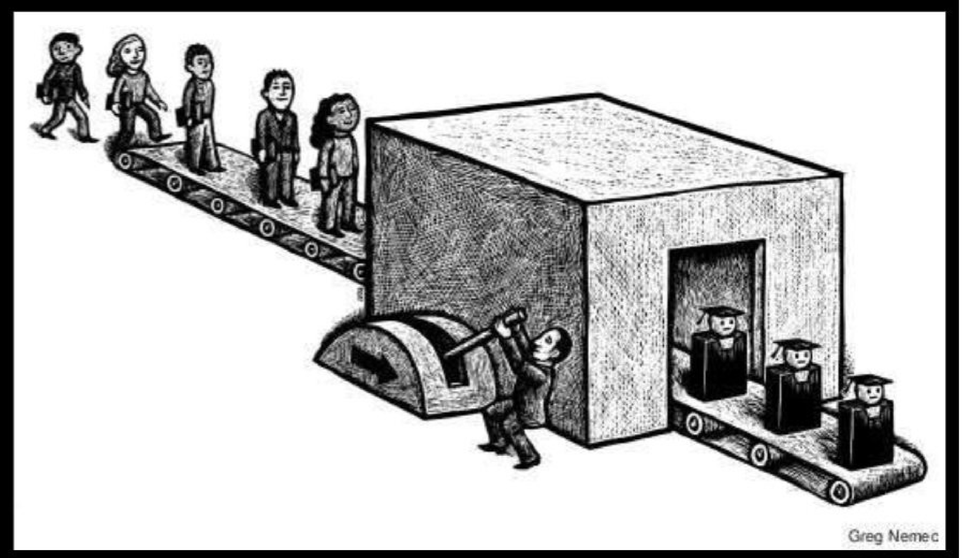


Image Source: https://www.linkedin.com/

Vision of True Education

- **True Education:**
  - ✓Provides direction for societal progress.
  - ✓Cultivates holistic understanding
  - ✓Ensures harmony and sustainable living.
- **Aligns with basic aspirations for happiness and prosperity.**

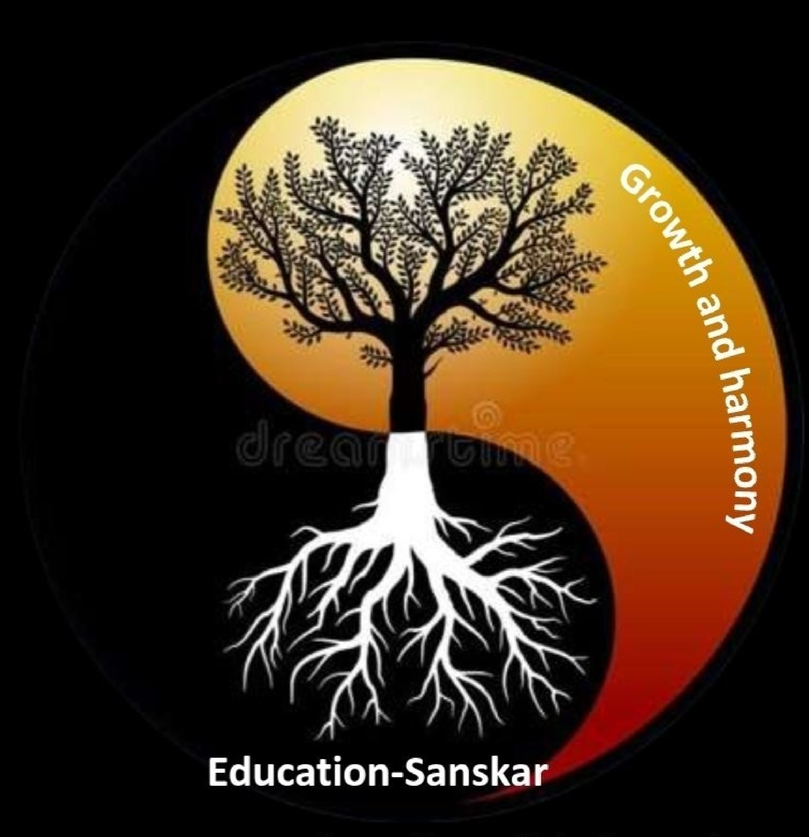


Image Source: https://www.linkedin.com/

Exploring the Meaning of Happiness and Prosperity

What is Happiness?

- **Definition:** Happiness is a state of harmony within oneself and with what is naturally acceptable.
- **Key Concept:**
  - ✓Happiness = Harmony
  - ✓Unhappiness = Disharmony
- **Example:**
  - ✓Resolving a conflict brings happiness.
  - ✓Disharmony in relationships or situations leads to



Image Source: https://iasbaba.com/

Continuity of Harmony

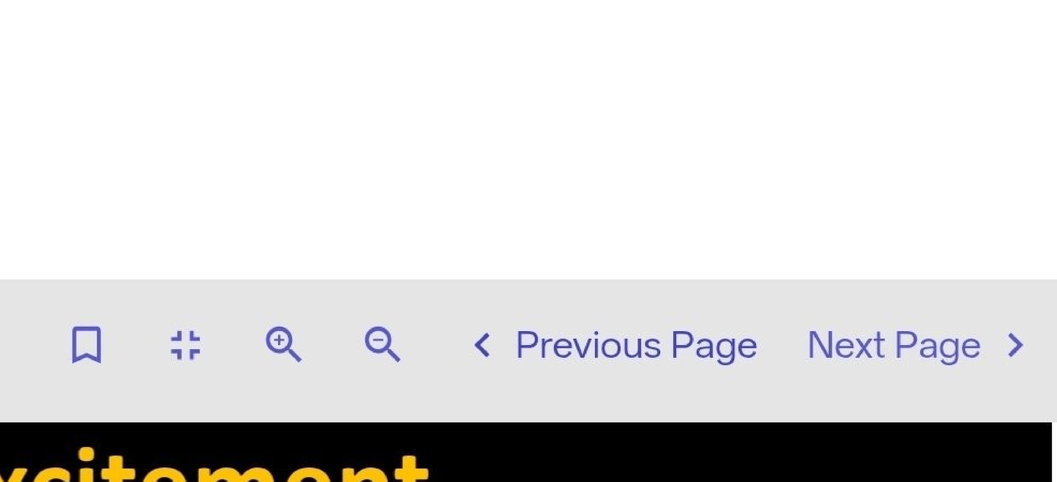
- **Harmony in Personal Interactions:**
  - ✓Mutual respect and affection in relationships create happiness.
  - ✓Disharmony, like conflict or dominance, causes unhappiness.
- **We naturally seek continuity of harmony.**



Image Source: https://dpspatnaeast.com/

Happiness vs. Excitement

- **Excitement:** A momentary, fleeting joy from sensations or feelings.
  - ✓Example: Eating sweets or receiving praise.
- **Happiness:** A deeper, sustained state of harmony within.



Key Differences Between Happiness and Excitement

Aspect	Happiness 🧘	Excitement 🎉
Source	Comes from **inner peace and harmony.**	Comes from **external experiences.**
Duration	**Long-lasting** and stable.	**Short-lived** and temporary.
Effect	Leads to **contentment and emotional balance.**	Can lead to **imbalance if excessive.**
Example	**Loving relationships, inner peace, meaningful work.**	**Winning a lottery, eating junk food, social media likes.**

What is Prosperity?

- **Definition:** The feeling of having more than enough physical facilities.
- **Key Elements:**
  - ✓Accurate assessment of physical needs.
  - ✓Ensuring availability/production beyond those needs.
- **Example:**
  - ✓Determine how much food is needed or



Image Source: https://iStock.com/

The Feeling of Deprivation

- **Lack of Prosperity:**
  - ✓ Arises when needs are not accurately assessed or fulfilled.
- **Cycle of Accumulation:**
  - ✓ Belief: More wealth = More prosperity.
  - ✓ Result: Endless accumulation and exploitation.
- **True prosperity is the balance of needs and sustainable production.**



Image Source: https://VectorStock.com/

Prevailing Notions of Happiness

1. Happiness from Physical Facilities:

- ✓ Temporary and dependent on sensations.
- ✓Example: Eating chocolate — enjoyable at first, unpleasant if overdone.

2. Happiness from Others' Feelings:

- ✓Dependent on external validation (e.g., praise, criticism).
- ✓Unreliable and unsustainable.



Image Source: https://Dreamstime.com/

Program for Continuity of Happiness

- **Levels of Harmony:**
  - ✓ **Individual Level: Clarity in desires, thoughts, and actions.**
  - ✓ **Family Level: Mutual affection and responsibility.**
  - ✓ **Societal Level: Justice, respect, and cooperation.**
  - ✓ **Nature/Existence Level: Symbiotic relationship with the environment.**



- **Happiness = Harmony at All Levels.**

Examples of Harmony and Disharmony

- **Individual Level:**
  - ✓Harmony: Balanced desires and actions.
  - ✓Disharmony: Inner conflicts and stress.
- **Family Level:**
  - ✓Harmony: Mutual care and understanding.
  - ✓Disharmony: Conflicts and dominance.



Examples of Harmony and Disharmony

- **Society Level:**
  - ✓Harmony: Cooperation and fairness.
  - ✓Disharmony: Exploitation and injustice.
- **Nature Level:**
  - ✓Harmony: Sustainable living.
  - ✓Disharmony: Overexploitation.



Key Takeaways

- **Happiness:** A state of harmony, not excitement or dependence on external factors.
- **Prosperity:** The feeling of having enough, rooted in accurate assessment and sustainable production.
- **Continuity of Happiness:** Ensuring harmony at all levels of living.
- Action Plan: